

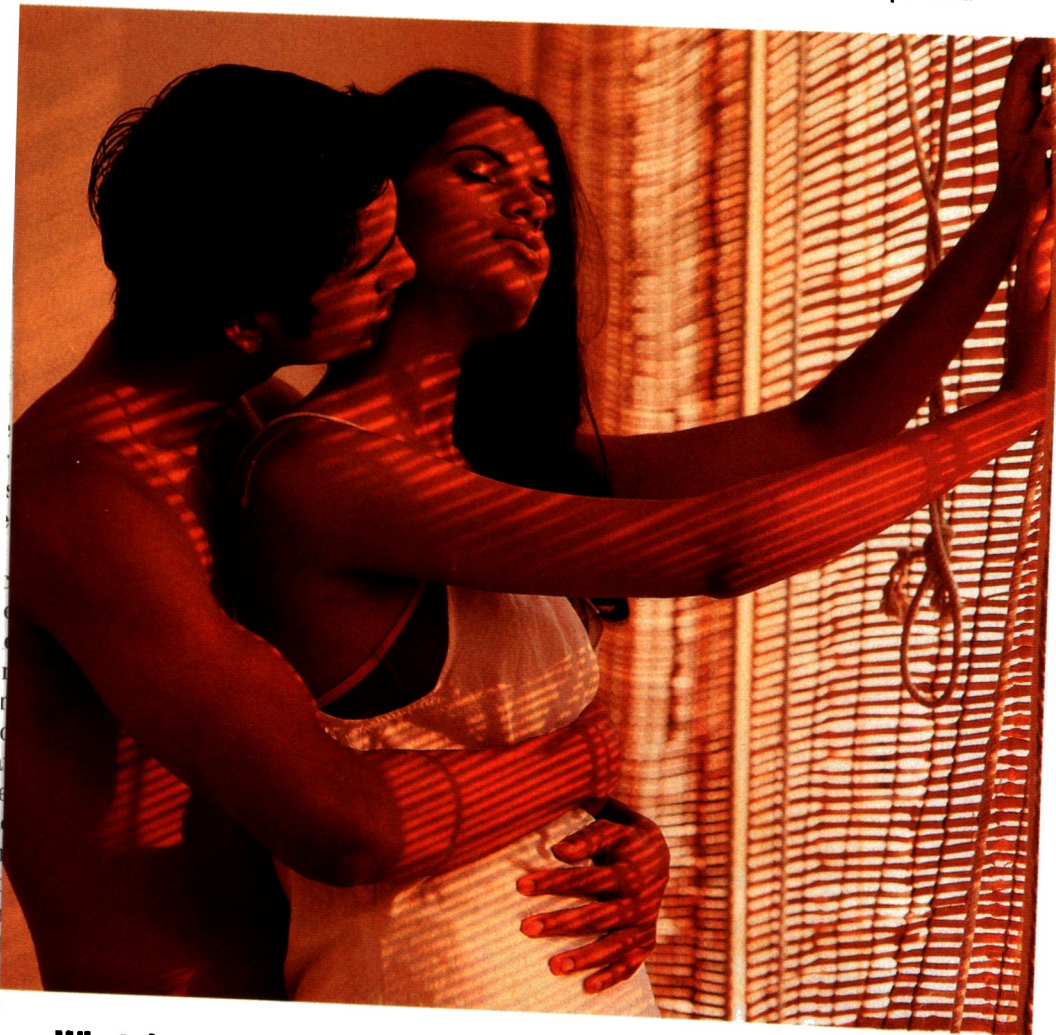
38% PATNA RESPONDENTS SPEND MAXIMUM TIME ON FOREPLAY

Do you have foreplay before sex?

		MALE	FEMALE
Do not generally have foreplay	13	12	14
For 5 minutes	27	28	27
For 10 minutes	30	31	30
How long does it take to get your partner into the mood?	25	25	24

LIGHTING THE FIRE

Men's preferences in foreplay have not changed compared to the 2004 male survey. But there is a stark difference in women. They want more foreplay. Their desire for kissing has jumped from 55 per cent in 2003 to 67 per cent.



What do you prefer in foreplay?

		MALE	FEMALE
Kissing	68	69	67
Massage	40	42	37
Looking at the body	30	40	20
Undressing partner	29	37	21
Watching a blue film	7	7	7

GETTING STARTED

The percentage of males preferring to look at the body in foreplay is twice that of females. One does wonder about the 11 per cent women who don't know about their preferences. Ludhiana at 16 per cent scores highest when it comes to seeing blue films as part of foreplay.

All figures in per cent. Figures add up to more than 100 because of multiple choices.

sociologist, G.S. Ghurye, conducted what he claimed to be the first-ever survey of the 'Sex Habits of a Sample of Middle Class People of Bombay', a report which he presented at the second All-India Population and first Family Hygiene Conference of 1938. The larger ambience, as the occasion suggests, was the scientific interest and public curiosity generated by Havelock Ellis's *Psychology of Sex* and the works of American human biologist/ eugenicist Raymond Pearl. On the other hand were the strident writings of birth control advocates like Marie Stopes and Margaret Sanger, and the public controversies provoked by Katherine Mayo's notorious *Mother India*. This double invocation of 'science' and 'family hygiene' provided cover for probing a tabooed subject. Today, population control—coded as questions on 'contraception'—continues to give legitimacy to the investigation of Indian sexuality, while 'family hygiene' is re-coded as 'sexual health' in the context of HIV/AIDS. The difference between then and now is the great expansion of space for sexual pleasure to which many of the contemporary questionnaires point: questions on foreplay, on coital positions, on fantasies and desire, on sex-toys and pornography, and on strategies for revitalising flagging conjugal energies.

Though Ghurye's report referred to the sex habits of "middle class people", in fact he interviewed only men. Today, of course, women too are surveyed, and one of the interesting aspects of the 2007 INDIA TODAY survey is the discrepancy in the responses